



Indian Council of Philosophical Research: Set up in 1981, and split between its administrative headquarters in Delhi and an academic wing in Lucknow, in a complex declared unsafe by the Fire Department, it got Rs 6 crore in the last two years but surrendered half of it.

What to do? Close it.

Foreign Service Institute: A recent white elephant, it was set up in 1986 to provide training for Indian Foreign Service probationers.

And now? Its Rs 9 crore budget is spent on acting as a parking lot for senior officials. Its mid-career courses for serving diplomats are not taken seriously even by the Ministry of External Affairs.

Employment Exchange: After the Supreme Court ruled in 1996 that it wasn't mandatory to register at the exchanges for a Government job, both the number of job seekers and their success rate have declined.

Does it need to stay? No. Unlike these 945 exchanges, leading online job websites claim to have a database of 6.5 million job seekers and a monthly success rate of 10-15 per cent.

Sahitya Akademi: It spends Rs 15 crore a year to organise literary workshops and present awards. It makes news only during presidential elections, another hard fought one this time, won by Bengali writer Sunil Gangopadhyay.

Can it go? Yes.

State Trading Corporation: Set up in 1956 to handle bulk international trade, the Rs 10,000-crore organisation has been waiting for a makeover.

What can be done? Sell it.

Central Board of Film Certification: Every film shown

in a theatre or on tv has to pass through the board first but any interpretation of the Cinematograph Act, 1952 is unsatisfactory. Last year, it reviewed 1,146 Indian movies and 361 foreign films, subjecting them all to its archaic ratings system. **Do we need it?** No. How many people follow theatrical ratings, raise your hands please.

Indian Council of Social Science Research: With an annual grant of Rs 46 crore, distributed among 27 institutes across India, it should be producing cutting-edge research.

Why it needs to go? Even the Ministry of Human Resource Development review committee last year said it needs to be revamped.

All India Council for Technical Education: Set up in 1945, the council was meant to monitor the growth and quality of technical institutes in the country but it is better known for its court cases and its acting chairman's dual salary.

What to do with it? Develop another way to deal with the explosive growth of technical institutions, especially the foreign ones.

National Film Development

Corporation: Its new chairman Om Puri wants to use it to promote meaningful cinema, but there's enough of it now in the multiplexes.

What to do with it? Does the Government need to spend Rs 30 crore of public money to make movies over the next five years?

Sangeet Natak Akademi: With an annual budget of Rs 18 crore, it is the breeding ground for

turf wars, usually centred around the chairman of the day.

Will it be missed? Only for its ego clashes that keep the Capital's gossip mills churning and favours that keep several performing artistes going.

Indian Council of Historical Research: A handmaiden of politicians of the day, it took its time to recover from the purge of right-wing historians, which followed a purge of left-wing historians.

What can be done? Spend over Rs 9 crore it gets on good history departments.

Films Division: For 50 years, it has made 8,000 documentaries to promote the Government.

Verdict: It needs to go. Even the Geetakraishnan Committee report to the Information and Broadcasting Ministry said so.

Netaji Subhash National Institute of Sports: Set up in Patiala in 1961 to train coaches in methods of the day, it is still stuck in the past.

Does it need to stay? No. Because sport is a fast-changing sector, tapping into every science, from fluid dynamics to neurology. **bureau reports**

In an age of corporatised art forms, socialist-era organisations that disburse state patronage are anachronisms.

